

CerbaSeal

Commercial Framework

Three-Model Partner Strategy Brief

KEY INSIGHT

"The actual tool is the thing I'm least concerned about."
She already believes the enforcement layer works. The question is now: can it be delivered?

1

Pilot

Consulting engagement

€15k – €75k

2

Production License

Post-pilot software

€25k – €750k+/yr

3

Channel Partner

CerbaSeal to a consulting firm

Different question

CONTENTS

1	The Three Commercial Models — Why Separation Matters
2	Model 1 — Pilot as Consulting Engagement
3	Model 2 — Production Licensing (Post-Pilot)
4	Model 3 — Channel Partner Economics
5	The Hidden Pricing Multiplier
6	Operationalization Readiness — Answering Olivia's Questions
7	What This Means For The Next Call

SECTION 1

The Three Commercial Models

Why mixing them creates pricing confusion

CerbaSeal currently has three distinct commercial models embedded in a single pricing discussion. Each model has different buyers, different value propositions, different cost inputs, and different pricing logics. Conflating them creates confusion — on both sides of the conversation.

Model	Buyer	What They're Buying	Price Driver
1 · Pilot	The client	Discovery + workflow mapping + deployment + training + evidence + support + learning	Jesse's time and IP applied to their specific problem
2 · Production License	The client	Enforcement layer + updates + support + evidence tooling + future releases	Software value: scale, reliability, ongoing capability
3 · Channel Partner	A consulting firm	CerbaSeal embedded in their practice: exclusivity, repeatability, support, tooling	What CerbaSeal is worth to a firm across many clients

KEY PRINCIPLE

The most expensive mistake in early enterprise pricing is forcing a single number to represent all three models. A pilot can cost more than Year 1 of the annual license — that is completely normal in enterprise software. A channel partner deal is priced on capacity multiplied across many clients, not one.

Where The Current Conversation Lives

The current conversation with Olivia spans all three models simultaneously — which is why it feels complex. She is asking pilot questions (first engagement), license questions (what happens after), and channel questions (repeatability, exclusivity, scaling) in the same breath.

The right move is not to answer all three in one number. The right move is to name the models clearly and price each one separately. This document prepares that separation.

SECTION 2

Model 1 — Pilot as Consulting Engagement

The pilot is not buying software

FRAMING

The client in a Tier 2 pilot is not paying for ALLOW/HOLD/REJECT. They are paying to learn whether CerbaSeal can solve a governance problem inside their organization. That distinction matters — and it changes how the price is justified.

1

Pilot

A consulting engagement enabled by CerbaSeal

€15,000 – €75,000 (preferred anchor: €45,000 – €60,000)

WHAT THE CLIENT IS PAYING FOR:

- Workflow discovery and requirements mapping
- Deployment assistance and environment configuration
- Runtime configuration and authority class setup
- Operator training and onboarding
- Evidence package generation and review
- Bounded support window during the pilot period
- Pilot completion review with stakeholders
- Learning: does CerbaSeal solve this client's governance problem?
- Risk reduction: pilot converts unknown into known before annual commitment

The pilot price reflects implementation-weight work. It is not a software subscription — it is a time-bounded engagement to prove value in one specific workflow. Enterprise software does this constantly. Snowflake charges \$25k–\$50k for 90-day pilots. That fee is credited on conversion.

Why Pilot > Year 1 Annual License Is Normal

A common instinct is to price the pilot below or at the annual license to make conversion feel like a good deal. This is usually wrong for implementation-heavy products.

Scenario	Pilot	Year 1 License	Logic
Correct framing	€50,000	€40,000/yr	Pilot includes implementation. License is mostly software. Pilot can cost more.
Wrong framing	€20,000	€40,000/yr	Severely underprices the implementation and training work. Creates wrong expectations.
Strategic framing	€50,000 (credited)	€40,000/yr	Pilot fee credited on conversion. Reduces friction. Standard enterprise pattern.

COMMERCIAL LOGIC

The implementation and training work happens once. After the pilot, Year 1 of the annual license is mostly software — no discovery, no workflow mapping, no onboarding. That is why they are priced differently and should be presented differently.

SECTION 3

Model 2 — Production Licensing

What happens after a successful pilot

After the pilot, the client has proven CerbaSeal works for their workflow. They are no longer paying for discovery, deployment, training, or onboarding — those already happened. Now they are paying for ongoing access to the enforcement layer and its supporting infrastructure.

2

Production License

Ongoing access to the enforcement layer

€25,000 – €750,000+ per year (based on client profile)

WHAT THE CLIENT IS PAYING FOR:

The enforcement gate — ExecutionGateService with all 12 invariants

Audit trail and evidence pipeline (file-backed JSONL, hash chain, replay)

Evidence package generation and export tooling

Diagnostic and health services

Support window and issue resolution

Version updates and new capability releases

Authority class configuration updates as client roles evolve

NOT PAYING FOR (ALREADY DONE / NOT INCLUDED):

Workflow discovery (already done)

Initial deployment (already done)

Operator training (already done)

Pilot stakeholder review (already done)

Annual licensing should not be finalized until after at least one successful pilot produces real data on usage volume, support burden, and ROI. The ranges below are directional — pilot data will anchor them.

License Type	Client Profile	Annual Range	Basis
Emerging Market	Seed / Series A / small AI company	€25k – €75k	Low volume, single workflow, limited regulatory exposure
Growth	Series B / scale-up / mid-market	€75k – €250k	Multiple workflows or high decision volume
Regulated Enterprise	Financial services, insurance, healthcare, legal, government	€250k – €750k+	Regulatory scrutiny, evidence requirements, multi-team use
Strategic Platform	Multi-workflow, multi-entity, high-consequence	€750k+	Enterprise-wide deployment, multiple business units

The Critical Inflection Point

The moment the first pilot converts to an annual license is the most important commercial event. It produces: (1) a referenceable customer, (2) real usage data, (3) a proven conversion path, (4) the ROI evidence needed to justify higher pricing to the next client.

• T
im
e
sa
ve
d
in

au
dit
pr
ep
ar
ati
on
p
er
go
ve
rn
ed
w
or
kfl
ow

- R
ed
uc
tio
n
in
m
an
ua
l a
pp
ro
val
re
vie
w
bu
rd
en
 - N
u
m
be
r
of
go
ve
rn
ed
d
eci
sio
ns
pr
oc
es
se
d
pe
r p
eri
od
-

- Number of unauthorized actions prevented
 - Evidence retrieval time vs. manual baseline
 - Support hours required per quarter
-

SECTION 4

Model 3 — Channel Partner Economics

A completely different pricing question

FROM THE CALL

Listen carefully to the call. Olivia repeatedly talks about future clients, multiple pilots, EU exclusivity, hosting eventually, repeatability, scaling, and support boundaries. Those are not pilot discussions. Those are channel discussions.

The channel model is not Client !' CerbaSeal. It is Client !' Partner !' CerbaSeal. This changes the pricing question fundamentally.

Direct Model (Models 1 & 2)	Channel Model (Model 3)
Jesse sells to each client individually	Partner bundles CerbaSeal into their service offering
Jesse deploys for each client	Partner deploys using starter kits and config tools
Jesse supports each client	Partner provides first-line support; Jesse provides second-line
Revenue: €35k–€75k per pilot	Revenue: partner fee + per-pilot or per-seat royalty
Ceiling: Jesse's available hours	Ceiling: partner's client base × deal size
Founder dependency: high	Founder dependency: low (partner is the delivery layer)

What CerbaSeal Is Worth To A Consulting Firm

The right pricing question for a channel partner is not 'what does a pilot cost?' It is 'what is CerbaSeal worth to a firm that can embed it across 10, 20, or 50 client engagements?'

Pricing Component	What It Covers	Example Structure
Platform access fee	Rights to use CerbaSeal in client engagements; updates; roadmap input	€30k–€80k/year depending on partner tier
Per-pilot royalty	Fee per client pilot delivered by the partner	€5k–€15k per pilot (volume-scaled)
Per-seat / per-decision	Production usage at client sites (post-pilot)	€X per governed decision per month or per active seat
Exclusivity premium	Geographic or vertical exclusivity (e.g. EU financial services)	Negotiated — typically 1.5–3× standard access fee
Training & certification	Partner team onboarding, certification program	€5k–€15k per cohort
Co-delivery support	Jesse's time on strategic accounts alongside partner	Day rate or retained hours

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION

What Olivia is describing is a channel partner relationship — not a series of individual client pilots. The commercial value of a channel partner deal is: (partner client base) × (average deal size) × (royalty rate). That is a materially different number than a single pilot fee, and it should be negotiated as a separate agreement.

What A Channel Agreement Should Cover

- Scope of rights — which works, which geographies, which verticals (exclusive boundaries)
- Partner obligations — minimums

s
pe
r y
ea
r,
ce
rtif
ica
tio
n r
eq
uir
e
m
en
ts,
su
pp
ort
c
ov
er
ag
e

• R
oy
alt
y s
tru
ct
ur
e
—
pe
r-p
ilot
fe
e,
pe
r-s
ea
t f
ee
,
or
re
ve
nu
e
sh
ar
e (
wh
ich
m
od
el
de
pe

nd
s
on
p
art
ne
r's
pr
ef
err
ed
st
ru
ct
ur
e)

• S
up
po
rt
bo
un
da
ry
—
wh
at
pa
rtn
er
ha
nd
les
vs
.w
ha
t e
sc
al
at
es

to
Je
ss
e (
cri
tic
al
for
fo
un
de
r-ti
m
e
pr
ot
ec

tion)
n)

- E
xcl
usi
vit
y t
er
ms

—
du
rat
io
n,
re
ne
wa
l c
on
diti
on
s,
pe
rfo
rm
an
ce
re
qu
ire
m
en
ts
to
m
ai
nt
ai
n
ex
clu
siv
ity

- Co-

m
ar
ket
in
g
an
d r
ef
er
en
ce
ri

gh
ts
—
wh
at
th
e
pa
rtn
er
ca
n
sa
y
pu
bli
cly
a
bo
ut
th
e r
el
ati
on
shi
p
.

IP
pr
ot
ec
tio
ns

—
wh
at
th
e
pa
rtn
er
ca
n
an
d
ca
nn
ot
m
od
ify,
w
hit
e-l
ab
el,

or
re
dis
tri
bu
te

The Hidden Pricing Multiplier

Founder dependency reduction = revenue infrastructure

THE CORE INSIGHT

This is the thing neither the research report nor the pricing brief fully captures. Reducing founder hours per pilot from 8 to 2 does not improve the product. It multiplies revenue capacity — with the same founder, same product, same company.

The Capacity Equation

		TODAY (8h/pilot)		TARGET (2h/pilot)		
Scenario	h/pilot	Pilots/yr	Revenue	h/pilot	Pilots/yr	Revenue
500h available/yr	8h	62	€3.1M capacity	2h	250	€12.5M capacity
200h available/yr	8h	25	€1.25M capacity	2h	100	€5M capacity
100h available/yr	8h	12	€600k capacity	2h	50	€2.5M capacity
50h available/yr	8h	6	€300k capacity	2h	25	€1.25M capacity

WHY THIS MATTERS

Nothing changed technically. The enforcement gate is identical. The audit trail is identical. The tests are identical. But 2 founder hours per pilot instead of 8 means the same founder, same product, same company has 4× the revenue capacity. That is why the onboarding work, the starter kits, the config wizard, and the deployment automation are not documentation. They are revenue infrastructure.

The Channel Multiplier On Top

If the channel model activates — a partner is delivering pilots using CerbaSeal — the multiplier applies to the partner's team, not just Jesse's hours. The partner has more capacity than Jesse alone. Every hour Jesse invests in making CerbaSeal deliverable by others multiplies across the partner's practice.

Delivery model	Who does the pilot hours	Jesse's role	Pilots/yr ceiling
Direct today (8h/pilot)	Jesse	Everything	~12–62 depending on time available
Direct (target, 2h/pilot)	Jesse + tooling	Strategy + oversight	~25–250 depending on time available
Channel (partner-delivered)	Partner team + tooling	Second-line support only	Partner's capacity × their deal flow

CONTEXT

After reviewing the call, the biggest commercial risk Olivia sees is not whether CerbaSeal works. It is whether CerbaSeal can be delivered repeatedly without consuming the founder. These are the six questions she kept returning to — with current state, target, and status.

Q1 — How long does onboarding take?

Onboarding duration Now: Estimated 8–12h of founder involvement Target: < 4 hours of founder involvement PARTIAL	Self-service capability Now: Starter kits + config wizard exist Target: 90% of onboarding self-served PARTIAL
The Founder Independence Kit, 8-phase onboarding sequence, and 4 integration starter kits already reduce onboarding burden significantly. What's still needed: a recorded walkthrough, a deployment checklist with expected completion times, and timing data from a real pilot. 8-phase onboarding sequence (docs/client-a doption /onboardings-equipment). 4 i	

nt
eg
rat
io
n
st
art
er
kit
s
wit
h
R
E
A
D
M
Es

- W
or
kfl
ow
c
on
fig
g
en
er
at
or
(p
np
m
ge
ne
rat
e:
pil
ot-
co
nfi
g)
- F
ou
nd
er
In
de
pe
nd
en
ce
Ki
t (
do
cs/
F
O

UNDER-DEPENDENCE-KIT.m d)

- R
ec
or
de
d
wa
lkt
hr
ou
gh
vi
de
o (
no
t y
et
bui
lt)
 - T
im
ed
c
o
m
pl
eti
on
d
at
a f
ro
m
a r
ea
l pi
lot
-
-

Q2 — How much founder involvement per pilot?

Founder hours per pilot	NEEDED	Delegation tools	PARTIAL
Now: Unknown — not yet measured Target: < 5 hours per pilot		Now: Starter kits reduce dev hours Target: Partner delivers 80% without Jesse	

This is the most important number to establish. Until it is measured from a real pilot, any capacity claim is theoretical. The first pilot should explicitly track founder hours by activity: discovery, configuration, deployment, training, support, review.

- H
ou
r tr
ac
kin
g
by
ac
tivi
ty
ty
pe
(d
isc
ov
er
y /
c
on
fig
/
de
pl
oy
/ tr
ai
n /
s
up
po
rt /
re
vie
w)
- C
on
fig
g
en
er
at
or
re
du
ce
s c
on
fig
ur
ati
on
ti

me

- Starter kit
s r
ed
uc
e
de
pl
oy
m
en
t ti
m
e

- Support
po
rt
pl
ay
bo
ok

to
re
du
ce
s
up
po
rt
ho
ur
s

- Training
ni
ng
m
at
eri
als

to
re
du
ce
tr
ai
ni
ng
h
ou
rs

Q3 — How much training is required?

Operator training

PARTIAL

Now: Documented; no video format

Target: 30-min onboarding video + reference guide

- Onboarding session equipment documentation
- 4 starter kits with working examples and README files
- CLI script reference (a

Developer integration

PARTIAL

Now: 4 starter kits + READMEs

Target: Developer self-serves with < 2h of guidance

II 2
4
pn
p
m
co
m
m
an
ds
d
oc
u
m
en
te
d)

.
30-

mi
nu
te
on
bo
ar
di
ng
vi
de
o f
or
op
er
at
or
s

.
5-
mi
nu
te '
wh
at
is
Ce
rb
aS
ea
l' e
xpl
ai
ne
r f
or
st
ak
eh
ol

de
rs
• D
ev
el
op
er
qu
ick
st
art
g
ui
de
wi
th
st
ep
-b
y-s
te
p f
ro
m
ze
ro

Q4 — Can a client deploy without Jesse?

Self-deployment capability

PARTIAL

Now: Probably — tools exist but untested end-to-end

Target: Yes — tested and documented

• un
tim
e
co
nfi
g
in
ce
rb
as
ea
l.c
on
fig
.js
on
(n
o
co
de
c
ha
ng
es
fo
r cl
ie

Deployment documentation

PARTIAL

Now: Deployment guide exists

Target: Step-by-step guide verified by non-Jesse run

nt
rol
es
)

- D
ep
loy
m
en
t
m
od
es
d
oc
u
m
en
t (
do
cs/
de
pl
oy
m
en
t/d
ep
loy
m
en
t-
m
od
es.
m
d)
- P
ilot
d
ep
loy
m
en
t c
he
ckl
ist
(d
oc
s/
de
pl
oy
m
en
t/p
ilot
-d

ep
loy
m
en
t-c
he
ckl
ist.
m
d)

- E
vid
en
ce
p
ac
ka
ge
g
en
er
at
or
(p
np
m
ge
ne
rat
e:
evi
de
nc
e-r
ep
ort
)

- D
ep
loy
m
en
t g
ui
de
ve
rifi
ed

by
a
no
n-
Je
ss
e r
un
(c
riti

cal
g
ap
)
• E
nvi
ro
n
m
en
t v
ari
abl
e
se
tu
p
gu
id
e
wit
h
ex
pe
ct
ed
va
lu
es

Q5 — Can a client generate evidence without Jesse?

Evidence generation Now: Fully automated via CLI scripts Target: Yes — runs in < 5 minutes	READY	Verification Now: pnpm verify:proof validates output Target: Client can verify independently	READY
READY NOW This is the strongest readiness answer. Evidence generation is fully automated and requires zero founder involvement: pnpm export:proof !' pnpm generate:evidence-report. Output: 3 files (governance summary, decision summary, audit integrity summary). Client can run this independently after initial setup.			

Q6 — Can a client troubleshoot without Jesse?

Self-service troubleshooting Now: Diagnostic service + health check exist Target: 80% of issues self-served	PARTIAL	Support playbook Now: Operator action service built Target: Documented decision tree for common issues	NEEDED
ia gn os tic Re po rtS er vic e — op			

er
at
or-
fac
in
g
an
aly
sis
wi
th
re
co
m
m
en
de
d
ac
tio
ns

- S
yst
e
m
He
alt
hS
er
vic
e
—
ch
ec
ks
lo
gg
in
g,
co
ntr
ols
, tr
us
t s
tat
e,
ch
ai
n i
nt
eg
rit
y

- O
pe
rat
or

Action Service — acknowledge, escalate, review, update, generate rate of support ticket

- T
ro
ubl
es
ho
oti
ng
g
ui
de
(d
oc
s/c
lie
nt-
ad
op
tio
n/t
ro
ubl
es
ho
oti
ng
-g
ui

de
.m
d)

- C
o
m
m
on
er
ror
d
eci
sio
n t
re
e (
wh
at
to
do
w
he
n
X
ha
pp
en
s)
- S
up
po
rt t
ier
d
efi
niti
on
(w
ha
t
is
sel
f-s
er
ve
vs.
e
sc
al
at
e
to
Je
ss
e)
- R
es
po
ns

Readiness Summary

Question	Status	Key Gap
How long does onboarding take?	PARTIAL	No timing data from a real pilot; no recorded walkthrough
How much founder involvement per pilot?	NEEDED	Not measured — first pilot must explicitly track this
How much training is required?	PARTIAL	Tools exist; no video format; not tested with real client
Can a client deploy without Jesse?	PARTIAL	Docs exist; not verified by a non-Jesse deployment
Can a client generate evidence without Jesse?	READY	Fully automated; zero founder involvement required
Can a client troubleshoot without Jesse?	PARTIAL	Services built; support playbook and decision tree needed

SECTION 7

What This Means For The Next Call

Reframes, talking points, and priorities

THE MOST IMPORTANT THING SHE SAID

"The actual tool itself is honestly the thing I'm least concerned about. I'm concerned about support, onboarding, operationalization, and deployment." — Olivia

She has already passed the technical credibility gate. The conversation is now about delivery confidence, not technical validation. Price accordingly.

Key Reframes For The Conversation

Old framing	Better framing
'Here is what CerbaSeal can do.'	'Here is how a client deploys CerbaSeal and what we deliver during the pilot.'
'391 tests passing, 15 audit checks.'	'The technical layer is solved. The delivery question is: can your team adopt it without needing Jesse at every step?'
'We charge €35k–€75k for a pilot.'	'The pilot fee covers workflow mapping, deployment, training, evidence generation, and support — not just the software.'
'After the pilot, you buy a license.'	'The pilot converts to an annual license for ongoing access to the enforcement layer. The implementation work is already done.'
'We're open to a channel relationship.'	'What you're describing sounds like a channel model — which means we should talk about partner access fees, royalties, and support boundaries separately from the first pilot.'

What To Prioritize Building Next

Stop researching competitors. The pricing data is sufficient to establish a defensible range. The next investments should answer Olivia's actual questions — not add more pricing research.

Priority	Deliverable	Answers	Time estimate
1 (highest)	Founder-hour tracking template for first pilot	Q2 — founder hours per pilot	2–3 hours
2	30-minute operator onboarding video	Q3 — how much training is required?	1 day
3	Support decision tree — common issues and self-serve resolution	Q6 — can client troubleshoot?	3–4 hours
4	Deployment verification run by a non-Jesse person	Q4 — can client deploy without Jesse?	Half day
5	Channel partner term sheet template	Model 3 discussion with Olivia	3–4 hours

6	5-minute 'what is CerbaSeal' stakeholder explainer	Olivia presenting to her clients	Half day
---	--	----------------------------------	----------

FINAL RECOMMENDATION

Pricing power comes from being able to answer 'yes' to all six of Olivia's questions with specificity and evidence — not from another week of pricing research. The technical credibility gate is passed. The delivery credibility gate is next.

Recommended Opening For The Next Call

SUGGESTED OPENING

"I want to separate three things we've been discussing in the same conversation, because they have different structures and different price points.

The first is the pilot — which is a consulting engagement, not a software purchase. It covers workflow mapping, deployment, training, and evidence generation. That's where €35k–€75k lives.

The second is the annual license after a successful pilot. That's ongoing access to the enforcement layer — no implementation work, mostly software. That can be priced below the pilot, and that's normal.

The third is what I think you're actually describing — a channel relationship where you deliver CerbaSeal to your clients. That has a completely different structure: partner access fee, per-pilot royalty, support boundaries. Can we talk about which of these is the right frame for us right now?"

